

Digital Alliance

THE DIGITAL ALLIANCE.

Creating lasting connections through digital networking. A workshop for FTC teams.

Today's Presenters

Trevor Bedson

Team Captain & Lead Programmer on 8569 RoboKnights

Tanay Vinaykya

Programmer on 8569 RoboKnights

ORIGINALLY BY

Ishaan Luthra

Outreach Lead on 8569 RoboKnights

team8569 | team22377 | team5795

STRANGERS SAID YES.

Senior engineers. University directors. Fortune 500 communications. None of them knew us before the message.

**Same four step structure. Different platforms.
Repeatable. The skill goes far beyond robotics.**

team8569 | team22377 | team5795



Akshat
Apple, SpaceX



Israel
IBM



Nicholas
Boeing



Beren
Intel

THREE TEAMS. ONE SYSTEM.

Sponsors, mentors, university tours, international contacts. Same playbook across 8569, 22377, and 5795.

TEAM

8569

ROBOKNIGHTS

Multi-year sponsor relationships through LinkedIn first contact.

TEAM

22377

SIGMACORNS

Zero contacts to active alumni and university network in one season.

TEAM

5795

BACK TO THE DRAWING BOARD

Cross-team mentorship and university outreach pipeline.

RUN OF SHOW.

Yellow rows are hands on. Phone or laptop, wifi, pair with whoever is sitting next to you.

02 min	Hook + credentials	TEACH
03 min	Four step framework	TEACH
08 min	Polish your team LinkedIn	HANDS ON
07 min	Find three real targets	HANDS ON
04 min	Bad msg vs good msg	CRITIQUE
02 min	The spiral, Gmail, Instagram	TEACH

02 min	The problem + the shift	TEACH
02 min	Platforms: LinkedIn, IG, Gmail	TEACH
02 min	LinkedIn alumni + filters	DEMO
02 min	Who to avoid	TEACH
10 min	Draft + peer feedback	HANDS ON
02 min	Takeaways + Q&A	CLOSE

WHY MOST TEAMS FAIL.

GENERIC

NO CONNECTION

AIMED TOO HIGH

TOO LONG, NO ASK

IT'S A SYSTEM, NOT A SCRIPT.

Send fewer, more catered messages. Once you write for the reader, response rates change overnight.

THE FRAMEWORK.

Four steps. In order. Every time.

STEP 01

RIGHT
PEOPLE

STEP 02

QUICK
INTEREST

STEP 03

YOU + WHY
THEM

STEP 04

CLEAR
ASK

Digital Alliance

MATCH THE PLATFORM.

No special access. Just understanding people. Same framework, different register.



LINKEDIN

PRIMARY / QUICKEST
REPLIES



INSTAGRAM

INFORMAL / LOCAL



GMAIL

LOWEST REPLY RATE

ACTIVITY 01 / 08:00

SET UP YOUR TEAM PAGE.

Before any outreach, your profile must look real and active.

Five fields, eight minutes. Pair check at five.

THE FIVE FIELD CHECKLIST

Headline. Team number + city + season goal.

Profile photo. Team logo, square, high contrast.

About. Three sentences. Who, what, why care.

Banner. Real photo of your team, not stock.

Featured + posts. Pinned link, plus one recent post for activity.

LINKEDIN, UP CLOSE.

The highest leverage skill in this workshop. Three features
get you 80% of the way.

01

Alumni network filter

Search a local university, filter by city + role. Instant warm targets.

02

Local company search

People filter, by company + city. Find the engineer, not the CEO.

03

Connection request note

Always include the note. 200 chars, four-step framework. Never blank.

ACTIVITY 02 / 07:00

FIND THREE TARGETS.

Local only, within 50 miles. Write the names down. We use one in the next activity.

- 01 Local alumnus**
LinkedIn alumni filter on a nearby university. Engineer, designer, or PM.
- 02 Local business or makerspace**
Use Instagram or Google. Cafe, machine shop, hardware store, fab lab.
- 03 FIRST Alumn nearby**
Search "FIRST robotics" + your city + "alumni" or "mentor".

SKIP THESE.

Local first, always. The system breaks the moment you stop being personal.

BIG COMPANY COLD

If you cannot name what they personally do in one sentence, you are not ready.

CEOS AND EXECS

Reach the engineer, the recruiter, the comms manager. They reply, and they refer.

GHOST ACCOUNTS

Last post three years ago. Move on. Do not waste the message.

THE BAD MESSAGE.

Read it out loud and give me three things wrong.

LINKEDIN / CONNECTION REQUEST

300/300

Hi sir,

My name is [NAME] and I am a student on a high school robotics team. We are doing very well and looking for sponsors and mentors.

I saw your profile and you seem like a very accomplished engineer. Any help would be greatly appreciated. Please let me know if you are interested in supporting us in any way.

Thank you for your time.

THE GOOD MESSAGE.

Same target, different result. Each colored span is one of the four steps.

- 01 Right people
- 02 Quick interest
- 03 You + why them
- 04 Clear ask

LINKEDIN / MESSAGE

287/300

Hi Priya,

Your talk at the Boston Maker Summit on rapid prototyping for hardware startups stuck with our team.

I lead outreach for FTC Team 8569 in Durham, NC. We are working on a custom autonomous system utilizing Model Predictive Control, and your points on control theory really inspired us.

I'd love to talk more about your engineering journey. Could we set up a time to talk?

ACTIVITY 03 / 10:00

WRITE YOURS. RIGHT NOW.

Pick one of your three targets. Match the platform. Six minutes draft, four minutes peer feedback.

YOUR DRAFT / 4 LINES

01 / GREET BY FIRST NAME

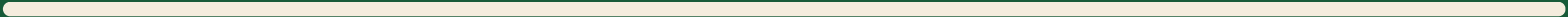
02 / ONE SPECIFIC THING THEY DID

03 / WHO YOU ARE + WHY THEM

04 / ONE SMALL ASK

ONE REPLY, MANY DOORS.

A network compounds. One reply turns into a referral, a referral turns into three more replies.



Reply received

Save + warm follow-up

Ask "who else?"

3 referrals, 3 new threads

GMAIL + INSTAGRAM.

Different lengths, different tones, different ways of finding the address.

GMAIL

LOWEST REPLY / FORMAL

Subject line does the work. Under 120 words. Always include team site + FIRST link.

Find emails via the company site, LinkedIn, or "@company.com" Google search.

INSTAGRAM

INFORMAL / LOCAL

Two to three sentences. Reach FIRST teams, local businesses, makers, communities. Reference one of their posts. DM after liking 2-3 posts first.

SEND IN 48 HOURS.

You leave with all three. Screenshot this slide.



Pick your target
tonight

Polish the four-line
draft

Choose the platform

Send within 48 hours

Digital Alliance

STAY SPECIFIC, STAY LOCAL.

Thank you. Find us at:

8569 / RoboKnights

22377 / SigmaCorns

5795 / Back To The Drawing Board

team8569 | team22377 | team5795

Trevor Bedson



Tanay Vinaykya

